

PepsiCo x Purdue UX

PROJECT PLAN

UXD Experience Studio | Fall 2026 | TEAM 09

Contact Information

Purdue UXD Students

Jun Hyok Lim	lim362@purdue.edu
Ashton Sun	sun1278@purdue.edu
Ani Berry	berry173@purdue.edu
Jocelyn Chan	chan567@purdue.edu
Christina Hittle	hittlec@purdue.edu
Andrew Lehner	lehner2@purdue.edu

Purdue UXD Instructors

Nancy Rasche, Professor	nrasche@purdue.edu
Pratyush Bisht	bishtp@purdue.edu
Rhiannon Morris	morri990@purdue.edu
Mallika Venkatesh	venka144@purdue.edu

Sponsors

Grace Goudreau	grace.goudreau@pepsico.com
Jennifer Portanka	jennifer.portanka@pepsico.com
Kara Davis	kara.davis@pepsico.com
Namitha Karupakula	namitha.k@pepsico.com

Company Description

PepsiCo is a global food and beverage company with a portfolio of well-known brands across snacks, beverages, and nutrition, serving consumers in markets around the world. The company operates at a large scale, combining manufacturing, distribution, marketing, technology, and digital services to support its products and business operations.

Project Description

PepsiCo's **JOY rewards system** is an existing consumer-facing loyalty platform serving European Union markets. JOY allows users to participate in promotions, redeem rewards, and receive prizes and discounts via a web-based experience. PepsiCo is seeking to improve the overall user experience of the web-based rewards and redemption flow, explore meaningful ways artificial intelligence can be incorporated, and establish a themable design system that can be adapted across PepsiCo's broader brand portfolio (e.g., Pepsi, Lay's, Doritos, 7UP, etc.).

Problem Statement

As consumer expectations for digital loyalty experiences continue to rise, the JOY EU platform has an opportunity to evolve through **smarter design and AI integration**. Users who find redemption flows **confusing, impersonal, or effortful** are likely to **disengage** entirely. Beyond the immediate UX improvements, PepsiCo sees an opportunity to build a flexible, scalable foundation where the JOY platform's AI-enhanced experience can be rebranded and deployed across multiple PepsiCo properties without rebuilding from scratch.

Project Goal

- Conduct user research to identify pain points in the current JOY EU web rewards and redemption flow
- Identify specific opportunities where AI can enhance personalization and discoverability.
- Design and prototype an improved JOY web experience that incorporates AI-driven features
- Develop a themeable design system that allows the experience to be reskinned for different PepsiCo

- brands
- Deliver actionable recommendations PepsiCo can use to inform future product development

Guiding Question:

How might we redesign the current consumer-facing loyalty program to improve the overall user experience of the web-based rewards and redemption flow while integrating AI in this journey?

Project Outcomes

The project will result in a redesigned and AI-enhanced rewards system experience that is intuitive, personal, and easy to use for Pepsico customers. The outcome includes an interactive web prototype of the redesigned JOY EU experience utilizing an established themeable design system that can be used across all Pepsico brands.

User Group/Stakeholders

Primary

Digitally savvy PepsiCo European Union consumers (college-age users from 18-24)

This user group is very large, however, we will be able to scope down further into the project having conducted initial research. We acknowledge that our user group is in Europe while we are located in the US. We plan to recognize this as a limitation, whilst doing our best to find European participants to interview and test with.

Stakeholders

Pepsico sponsors

Our sponsors will oversee and provide feedback for the team throughout the research and design process. We will hand over the final research report and design files to the sponsors.

Phases

P1: Discovery & Research

Goal

Assess the current reporting experience to uncover pain points and opportunities

Guiding Question:

What are the key user needs, pain points, and the system constraints within the current app?

Activities

1. Desk Research
    a. Method:
        - Review existing pepsico brands & branding guidelines
    b. Outcome:
        - List of brand guidelines and possible common patterns that can be synthesized into a themeable design system
2. Audit: Evaluating Existing Web Experience
    a. Method:
        - Heuristic evaluation
        - Cognitive walkthrough
        - Task Flow Analysis
        - Review major flows:
            - Registration
            - Promotion browsing
            - Reward discovery
            - Redemption
    b. Outcome:
        - List of pain points, usage, and areas for improvement
        - Problem framing and user need statements
        - Opportunities for redesign
3. Interviews
    a. Methods:
        - User Interviews
    b. Outcome:
        - Users' expectations for reward systems

        - Competitors to research further
        - Opportunities for AI integration
4. Competitive Analysis
    a. Method:
        - Review competitive loyalty platforms and multi-brand design systems for benchmarks
        - Evaluation of similar forms/applications
        - SWOT Analysis
    b. Outcome:
        - Identification of pros and cons of different features for an improved user request experience
        - Opportunities for differentiation
        - Design system benchmark

Outcomes

Gain primary and secondary research data to inform our ideation phase

- List of pain points, usage, and areas of improvement
- Problem framing and user need statements

P2: Synthesis & Ideation

Goal

Synthesize research in order to identify opportunity areas for design directions and AI integration. Establish the base component library, theming architecture, and begin sketching for sponsor feedback.

Guiding Question:

How can we create research informed ideations and designs that address our findings from P1 while maintaining a flexible, scalable foundation for further building and AI enhancements.

Activities

1. Brainstorming
    a. Method:

        - Whiteboard session where we generate a wide range of ideas for improving the web experience.
    b. Outcome:
        - A collection of design ideas that inform the direction of the web redesign.
2. Low-Fidelity Sketching:
    a. Method:
        - Rapid low-fidelity sketching (crazy 8's) to explore layouts, navigation, and user flows for the desktop experience.
    b. Outcome:
        - Early design concepts that establish structure and guide wireframing.
3. Design System Prototyping
    a. Method:
        - Utilizing design system best practices and synthesizing existing branding guidelines to establish foundations for a themeable design system
    b. Outcome
        - Foundations and base component library for a themeable design system including color, typography, iconography, and tone of voice guidelines that can be swapped to reflect different PepsiCo brands

Outcomes

- Research report including user insights, usability findings, and AI integration recommendations
- Foundations and base component library for a themeable design system
- Sketches that portray multiple design directions

P3: Design & Prototype

Goal

Develop a high fidelity prototype that demonstrates an AI-enhanced redemption flow and usability findings. Apply and demonstrate themability of systems and conduct user testing.

Guiding Questions:

How might we create a refined high fidelity prototype adaptable to themability based on user insights and AI integration?

Activities

1. Wireframing
    a. Method:
        - Wireframing that defines the overall content hierarchy, layout, and placements.
    b. Outcome:
        - Wireframes that clearly outline page layouts, content structure, and placements to guide prototyping and testing.
2. AI-assisted prototyping
    a. Method:
        - AI-assisted prototyping to generate early layout and placement concepts that support rapid prototyping and iteration.
    b. Outcome:
        - Generated design frames that serve as a structural guide for usability testing, allowing faster usability testing and more effective feedback collection.
3. Usability testing
    a. Method:
        - Conduct usability testing using AI tool-generated designs to evaluate layout placements, design concepts, and overall usability.
    b. Outcome:
        - Actionable feedback on design structure, clarity, and concept effectiveness to inform design refinements.
4. High-fidelity prototyping
    a. Method:
        - Utilizing established design systems and branding guidelines to prototype high-fidelity representations of the web experience
    b. Outcome:
        - High-fidelity web prototypes

Outcomes

- Interactive web prototype of the redesigned JOY EU experience demonstrating AI enhancements

- Themable design system with documented guidelines and at least two brand theme demonstrations

Projected Deliverables

Our final deliverables will highlight key design outputs and selected research insights.

1. High-fidelity Desktop Web Prototype

Interactive web prototype of the redesigned JOY EU experience utilizing established design systems.

2. Themable Design System

Themable design system with documented guidelines and at least two brand theme demonstrations.

3. Research Report

Research report including user insights, usability findings, and AI integration recommendations.

Weekly Schedule

Week	Goals/Activities	Due Dates/Events
Week 1 Aug 17, 19, 21	Syllabus stuff	
Week 2 Aug/Sep 31, 2, 4	Work on Kickoff Meeting Agenda Begin project plan	Kickoff meeting 9/4 (Fri)
Week 3 Sep ~~7~~, 9, 11	Revise project plan Work on proposal presentation Audit the current JOY EU web experience across key user flows Review competitive loyalty platforms and multi-brand design systems for benchmarks	Labor Day 9/7 (Mon)
Week 4 Sep 14, 16, 18	Work on proposal presentation Schedule user interviews and cognitive walkthrough on the existing web redemption flow	Proposal review presentations in small groups with POs
Week 5 Sep 21, 23, 25	User interviews and cognitive walkthrough Gather brand guidelines for PepsiCo sub-brands to inform the theming framework Begin setting architecture for themeable design system	
Week 6 Sep/Oct 28, 30, 2	Synthesize research into key insight statements and opportunity areas Explore where and how AI can be naturally and meaningfully integrated into the web flow	
Week 7 Oct 5, 7, 9	Sketch and concept multiple design directions for PepsiCo feedback	

Week	Goals/Activities	Due Dates/Events
	AI-assisted prototyping from sketches Schedule usability testing	
Week 8 Oct ~~12~~, 14, 16	Usability testing Work on midterm presentation	October Break – No class Monday (Oct 12)
Week 9 Oct 19, 21, 23	Work on midterm presentation Usability testing & Iteration Begin establishing base component library	Midterm design review presentations in small groups
Week 10 Oct 26, 28, 30	Synthesize usability testing findings Develop high-fidelity designs for the improved JOY EU web experience Start research on possible AI-integrations?	
Week 11 Nov 2, 4, 6	Build an interactive prototype demonstrating the AI-enhanced redemption flow - Apply at least two brand themes to demonstrate the themability of the system	
Week 12 Nov 9, 11, 13	Conduct iterative usability testing and refine	
Week 13 Nov 16, 18, 20	Conduct iterative usability testing and refine	
Week 14 Nov 23, ~~25~~, ~~27~~	Finalize prototype, design system, and research report Work on final presentation	Thanksgiving Break – No class Wednesday & Friday (Nov 25 & 27)
Week 15 Nov/Dec 30, 2, 4	**Final Presentations**	Final presentations in small groups, sponsors attend

Week	Goals/Activities	Due Dates/Events
Week 16 Dec 7, 9, 11	Individual deliverables (due Wednesday night)	#IND Deliverables due by Dec 9 (Wednesday midnight)
Week 17 Dec 14, 16, 18	Team Deliverables (due Monday night)	#TEAM Deliverables due by Dec 14 (Monday midnight)